Apocalypse





Hannibal dared to challenge Rome because he knew he was a great leader.
During his lifetime, to improve his strategic and martial skills, he had turned to the use of magic.
Once he was dead, the Black Rose chose him as her Horseman of the Apocalypse, and now he is War.

"And out came another horse, bright red. Its rider was permitted to take peace from the earth, so that people should slay one another, and he was given a great sword."

Revelation 6:4

Credits

Project Manager: Luca Bernardini
Art Director: Andrea Colletti
From an idea by Andrea Colletti
Game Designer: Marco Montanaro
Additional Game Design and Development: Diego Fonseca, Leonardo Romano, Michele Morosini
Graphic Director: Paolo Scippo
Graphic Design: Diana Maranzano, Elisa Fiore
Concept Artists: Giovanni Pirrotta, Vincenzo Pratticò, Eleonora Lisi
Lead 3D Sculptor: Fernando Armentano
3D Sculptor: Tommaso Incecchi
Translation: Elettra Nuzzo
Editing: Myles Schaller
Social Media: Luca Bernardini, Emiliano Caretti
Customer Care: Marco Presentino, Michele Morosini
Advertising: Fabio Braghettoni, Emiliano Caretti
Fulfillment: Michele Mirizio
Production: Fabio Braghettoni, Paolo Scippo
Playtest: Alterio Sofia, Angelini Alessandro, Benedetti Luca, Caprera Benito, Carotenuto Pasquale, Caruso Pietro, De Feo Luigi, Francescangeli Luca, Galmacci Flavio, Granitto Francesco, Macchioro Gabriele, Meucci Lorenzo, Milani Giovanni, Noschese Luca, Perra Luca, Pica Francesco, Polverari Giuliano, Punzo Giovanni, Sabatini Alice, Samele Daniele, Schiariti Andrea, Spagnoletto Chiara, Vella Andrea, Vendittozzi Daniele

Contents

Components **4**
Standard Game **6**
Apocalypse Mode **7**
Game Setup for Apocalypse Mode **7**
Apocalypse Game Rules **7**
Feats 7
Library 7
Using the Options 7
Tournament Mode **8**
Creating a Mage **8**
Creation Points **8**
Creating a Mage **8**
Feats **8**
Mage Model *8*
Physical Action Feats 9
Library Feats 9
Trait Feats 9
Feats List *9*
Creating a Personal Library **10**
Building Rules 10
Tournament Game **10**
Change of Moon 10
Drawing Spell Cards 10
Tournament Mode Game Setup **10**
Tournament Format **11**
Options **11**
Plentiful Quests 11
Crown of the Summoner 11
Quick Study 11
Magic Tutor 11
Instinctive Spell 11
Rules Updates **12**
Limited and Banned Spell Cards 12
Rules 12



Hypatia was a great philosopher and one of the first great alchemists.
She studied the treatises and tools of Mary the Prophetess before they were destroyed.
Killed by the crowd, she was chosen by the Black Rose as her champion of the Apocalypse, and became Pestilence.

"And I looked, and behold, a huge hound! And its rider had a bow, and a crown was given to her, and she came out conquering, and to conquer."

Revelation 6:2

Components



36 Famine Spell Cards



36 War Spell Cards



36 Death Spell Cards



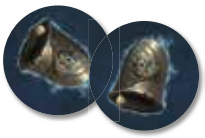
36 Pestilence Spell Cards



4 School Reference Cards



12 Personal Spell Cards



18 Destiny Tokens

These tokens are used by the **Death** School of Magic Effects.



18 Infectio Tokens

These tokens are used by the **Pestilence** School of Magic Effects.



4 Forgotten Spell Cards

Add these cards to the Forgotten Spells Deck of the core game.



18 Competitive Event Cards

In **Apocalypse Mode** and **Tournament Mode**, these Event Cards replace the core game ones.



6 Pestis Evocation Cards

Add these cards to the Evocation Cards Deck of the core game.



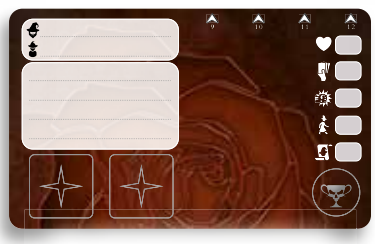
19 Evocation Cards

Add these cards to the Evocation Cards Deck of the core game.



4 Mage Cards / Apocalypse Mage Cards

Mage Cards are used in standard games. The Apocalypse Mage Card side is used in **Apocalypse Mode**.



50 Customizable Mage Cards

These Customizable Mage Cards are filled out to create your own Mage in **Tournament Mode**.



50 Tournament Sleeves

These sleeves are ideal for playing in **Tournament Mode**; they can be used for your Library and Forgotten Spells Deck.



FAMES



BELLUM



PESTILENTIA



MORS



10 PESTIS



6 LARGE MAGE BASES

1 for each color (6 colors)





2 ACTIVATION TOKENS

These tokens can be used in Tournament Mode.

Standard Game

Follow these directions to use the Apocalypse components in a standard *Black Rose Wars* game:

- Bellum, Fames, Mors and Pestilentia can be chosen as a Mage during step 8 of the Setup described in the core game rulebook. The player using one of these Mages must use the matching **Mage Card** on its standard side.



- You can change one or more of the Schools of Magic featured in the core game with the Schools of Famine, War, Death and Pestilence during step 9 of the Setup described in the core game rulebook.
- During step 9 of the Setup described in the core game rulebook, if one or more Mages were chosen among Bellum, Fames, Mors and Pestilentia in step 8, remove the following cards from the Forgotten Spells deck:
  - **Bellum:** the *Epic Finale* Forgotten Spell cannot be added.
  - **Fames:** the *Denutrition* Forgotten Spell cannot be added.
  - **Mors:** the *Requiem* Forgotten Spell cannot be added.
  - **Pestilentia:** the *Violent Epidemic* Forgotten Spell cannot be added.



Merneptah unleashed the plagues in Egypt.
A leader for many, famine for others.
The Black Rose chose him to be one of her Horsemen of the Apocalypse, Famine.

"And when the Lamb opened the third seal, I heard the third living creature say, "Come!" Then I looked and saw a black horse, and its rider held in his hand a pair of scales."

Revelation 6:5

Apocalypse Mode

Apocalypse Mode can be used as an introduction to the Tournament Mode (see next page): it is recommended to play at least one game of this mode before tackling Tournament Mode.
Apocalypse Mode allows games to be played by 2 to 4 players. Each player **must** choose a Horseman of the Apocalypse as their Mage, and will gain access exclusively to the School of Magic matched to them.

Game Setup for Apocalypse Mode

- Replace the Events Decks of each Moon Phase with the matching Competitive Events Deck during step 7 of the Setup.



- Only Bellum, Fames, Mors and Pestilentia can be selected as a Mage during step 8 of the Setup described in the core game rulebook. When using one of these Mages, the player must use the matching **Apocalypse Mage Card**.



- Do not form the Library during step 9 of the Setup described in the core game rulebook. Instead, each player obtains the School of Magic Deck associated with their Mage as shown below and places it next to themself:
  - **Bellum:** War
  - **Fames:** Famine
  - **Mors:** Death
  - **Pestilentia:** Pestilence
- During step 9 of the Setup described in the core game rulebook, remove the *Epic Finale, Denutrition, Requiem* and *Violent Epidemic* Cards from the Forgotten Spells deck.



Apocalypse Game Rules

A game in Apocalypse Mode uses all the standard rules of the core game, save for the following.

FEATS

In Apocalypse mode, each Mage has **Feats**, listed on their Mage Card. A Feat changes certain rules of the game for the Mage who has it. The list of Feats and their detailed explanation can be found on page 9.

LIBRARY

There is no shared Library; instead, each player has their own **Personal Library**, consisting solely of the deck obtained by the Mage during step 9 of the Setup.

Any Effect that would direct a Mage to draw cards from the Library instead causes that Mage to draw cards from their Personal Library. Effects that allow Forgotten Spell Cards to be drawn, on the other hand, follow the standard rules.

USING THE OPTIONS
Tournament Mode Options, shown on page 11, can also be used freely in Apocalypse Mode.

Tournament Mode

In Tournament Mode, each player can create the Mage of their dreams and their Personal Library through a points system that balances their potential.

Creating a Mage

Creation Points

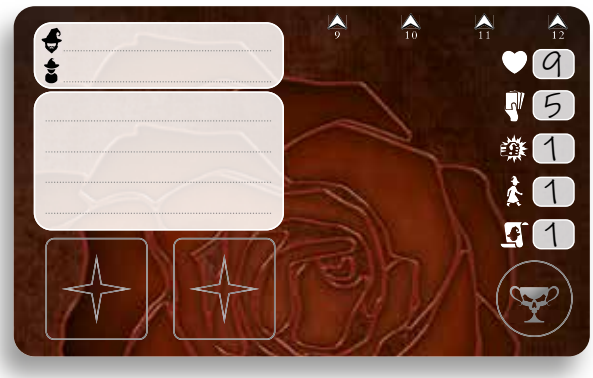
To create a Mage and Personal Library, a player has 10 **Creation Points** available; the player can spend all or some of these points to improve their Mage's **Characteristics** values and acquire **Feats** that will provide them with new and powerful options.



Creating a Mage

The first step in playing in Tournament Mode is to create your own Mage. To do this, use a Customizable Mage Card provided in this box. If you run out of them, you can download them for free at the Rebirth link on our website:
https://bit.ly/BRWR-Apocalypse

At the beginning of their formation, a Mage has the following values for their starting Characteristics:



For each individual Characteristic value you want to increase, you need to spend the corresponding **Creation Points** as shown in the chart below:

Starting Characteristics values		COST IN CREATION POINTS				
		1	2	3	4	5
♥	9	10	11	12		
	5	6	7	8	9	10
	1		2			3
	1		2	3		
	1	2	3	4		

After choosing how to spend **Creation Points** to change the Mage's Characteristics, the new values should be noted on the Customizable Mage Card.

MAGE MODEL

To represent your Mage in the Lodge, you can choose any Mage Model from Black Rose Wars.

Feats

Feats affect the rules of the game for the Mage who has them, and are acquirable during its creation. Each Feat alters or adds for the Mage who gains it a special rule, stated in its description, or gives them new Physical Actions to use by exhausting their Physical Action Tokens.

A Feat can be acquired by a Mage by spending Creation Points as shown in the chart on the following page.
Please note: each Feat can be acquired only once.

Once the Feats for the Mage have been chosen, they are to be noted on the Customizable Mage Card. There are three types of Feats, each denoted by a different symbol:
Physical Action ✚, Library ◎, Trait ★.

✚ PHYSICAL ACTION FEATS
This type of Feat grants new Physical Actions. For a full explanation of how Physical Actions work, see page 24 of the core game rulebook.

◎ LIBRARY FEATS
This type of Feat changes the creation parameters of the Personal Library.

★ TRAIT FEATS
These Feats change a game rule or give the Mage access to a special rule.

FEATS LIST

Creation Points	FEAT
3	**Channeling (Physical Action, ✚)** • **Move 1**. You can perform this Effect a number of times equal to your **Speed value**. Each separate Movement, separated by a period (.) counts as a different Effect; you can use all or part of them, but you cannot use other Effects between them. Unused Movements are lost. • **Place 1●** in a ⟨0⟩. • **Place 1●** in a ⟨1⟩ other than the Room you are in.
3	**Charge (Physical Action, ✚)** • **Move 1**. You can perform this Effect a number of times equal to your **Speed value**. Each separate Movement, separated by a period (.) counts as a different Effect; you can use all or part of them, but you cannot use other Effects between them. Unused Movements are lost. • **Perform** ✸ on a 0.
6	**Teleportation (Physical Action, ✚)** • **Place** yourself in a ⟨✳⟩. • **Activate** a ⟨0⟩.
2	**Study (Physical Action, ✚)** • **Draw 1◎** from your Personal Library. • **Activate** a ⟨0⟩.
3	**Dominion (Physical Action, ✚)** Choose one of your ✳. It **activates**. It has ✸**+1** for the duration of this Activation. At the end of the Activation the ✸ **inflicts 1** on it.
2	**Horde ★** At the beginning of the Cleanup Phase, heal all suffered by your Evocations.
1	**Creator ◎** You can include in your **Personal Library** up to three copies of a single Mage's **Personal Spell** (instead of none).
1	**Belligerent ◎** You can include up to **21** Spell Cards in your Personal Library (instead of **15**).
1	**Pacifist ◎** You can include up to **21** Spell Cards in your Personal Library (instead of **15**).
1	**Incautious ◎** You may include **0** or more Spell Cards (instead of at least **3**) in your Personal Library.
1	**Pragmatic ◎** You may include **0** or more Spell Cards (instead of at least **3**) in your Personal Library.
2	**Trimagic ◎** You can include Spell Cards from up to **3** different Schools of Magic in your Personal Library (instead of **2**).
1	**Builder ◎** You can include up to **21** Spell Cards displaying the ● symbol in the center in your Personal Library (instead of **18**).

Creating a Personal Library

Once the player has created their Mage, they must create their **Personal Library**.
The choice of Spell Cards to include in the personal Library must meet the following building rules, which can be modified by **Library Feats** chosen during the creation of the Mage.



BUILDING RULES

- The Personal Library must consist of exactly **36 Spell Cards**.
- Spell Cards included in the Personal Library can belong to a maximum of **2 different Schools of Magic**.
- **No Personal Spell Cards** can be included.
- **A maximum of 3 copies of the same Spell Card** can be included.
- **A maximum of 15 Spell Cards** can be included.
- **A maximum of 15 Spell Cards** can be included.
- **At least 3 Spell Cards** must be included.
- **At least 3 Spell Cards** must be included.
- **A maximum of 18 Spell Cards** displaying the symbol in their center can be included.
- The section Creating a Personal Library has been updated in case a Spell Card has 2 different symbols on Light Side and Dark Side.

Tournament Game

Tournament Mode games use the rules of the core game, save for the following:

CHANGE OF MOON

Mages do not gain the Personal Spell Card upon the change of Moon.

DRAWING SPELL CARDS

Any Effect that would direct a Mage to draw cards from the Library instead causes that Mage to draw cards from **their** Personal Library. The normal rules apply to Effects that allow you to draw Forgotten Spell Cards instead.

Tournament Mode Game Setup

- During step 1 of the Setup, arrange the Lodge as shown in the **Layout**.



- During step 7 replace the **Events Deck** from each Moon Phase with the corresponding **Competitive Events Deck**. Unlike what is described in the core game, **randomly** choose the player who gets the Crown Token () during this step.



- During step 8 players **do not choose a Mage**, but instead use the Model they chose for their Mage and use the **Customizable Mage Card** they previously filled out.
- During step 9 of the Setup described in the core game rulebook do not form the Library. Instead, each player places their own **Personal Library** next to them.
- During step 10 of the Setup described in the core game rulebook, instead of proceeding as indicated, follow these instructions:
  1. Each Mage shuffles their Personal Library before drawing seven cards from it and consulting them (these cards will form their Grimoire).
  2. **Mulligan:** each Mage may take a mulligan one single time, proceeding as follows:
     - They pick any number of drawn cards and set them aside, forming the mulligan pile.
     - They draw cards from their Library until they have a hand of seven.
     - Shuffle the mulligan pile into the Personal Library.
  3. Each Mage shuffles the seven drawn cards and uses them to form their **Grimoire**; they place it to the left of their Mage Sheet, in the Grimoire Slot (), then take the first card of the Grimoire and place it revealed in the Memories Slot of their Mage Sheet ().

Tournament Format

This chapter introduces a number of options that modify the rules of the core game.
By choosing one or more of these options to apply to your games in Tournament Mode, you will define your **Tournament Format**, through which you can disclose to all participants the variations from the core game.
New options and Tournament Formats will be released over time, and will be available in the game app (see p. 12).

Options

PLENTIFUL QUESTS

During **step 5** of the **Black Rose Phase**, each Mage who is to draw **1 Quest Card** draws **2** instead, chooses one of them to add to their Active Quests, and places the other at the bottom of the Quest Card Deck of the current Moon.

CROWN OF THE SUMMONER

Follow the optional rule indicated on page 30 of the core game rulebook, with the following exceptions:

- All Evocations under the Black Rose's control activate before the first Evocation activated by the First Player.
- In the case of Evocation Models which are not paired to a specific Evocation Card (such as **Pestis**), indicate their activation by placing one of your unused Tokens (e.g. Protection/Trap, Trophy, Persistent) next to the Model; remove this Token during step 1 of the next Cleanup Phase.

QUICK STUDY

Replace the rules of the **Study Phase** with the following:
In the Study Phase each Mage performs these steps:

- Draw **2 Spell Cards** from your own **Grimoire**.
- Draw **2 Spell Cards** from your own **Personal Library**.
- If they have more Spell Cards in their hand than their **Hand Value** (✋), they discard cards to their Memories until they have a number equal to their Hand Value.

When all the Mages have performed these points, the Study Phase ends.

MAGIC TUTOR

The Forgotten Spell Deck is not used in games where this option is applied: remove it from the game. During game setup, place the Activation Token A on the *Black Rose Room*. This token **is not** turned to the Exhausted side (it does not have it) when a Mage activates the *Black Rose Room*.
If the *Black Rose Room* is rebuilt, remove the A Token and place the Activation Token B on the Room. This token **is** turned to the Exhausted side when a Mage activates the *Black Rose Room*.
When this option is used, if a Mage has a chance to gain a Forgotten Spell for any reason (Effect of a Spell, Effect of a Quest, etc.), they do not gain it; instead, they search for a Spell Card from their Personal Library and add it to their Hand, then shuffle the Personal Library.



INSTINCTIVE SPELL

During the **Preparation Phase**, Mages do not place any Spell Cards in the Quick Spell slot.
During their Activation, when a Mage uses the **Cast a Spell** Action, they may place a Spell Card from their Hand in the Quick Spell slot in the Ready (covered) position. If they do, they must use the **Cast a Spell** Action to **reveal** (or **activate**, in the case of Trap or Protection Spells) the Spell in the Quick Spell slot.



LIMITED AND BANNED SPELL CARDS

The Personal Library can include any Spell Card taken from the Schools of the *Black Rose Wars: Rebirth* core box and the **Apocalypse** expansion.
New Schools will be added to those available for Tournament Mode.
The updated list of Spell Cards Restricted and Banned from Official Tournaments can be found on our website.

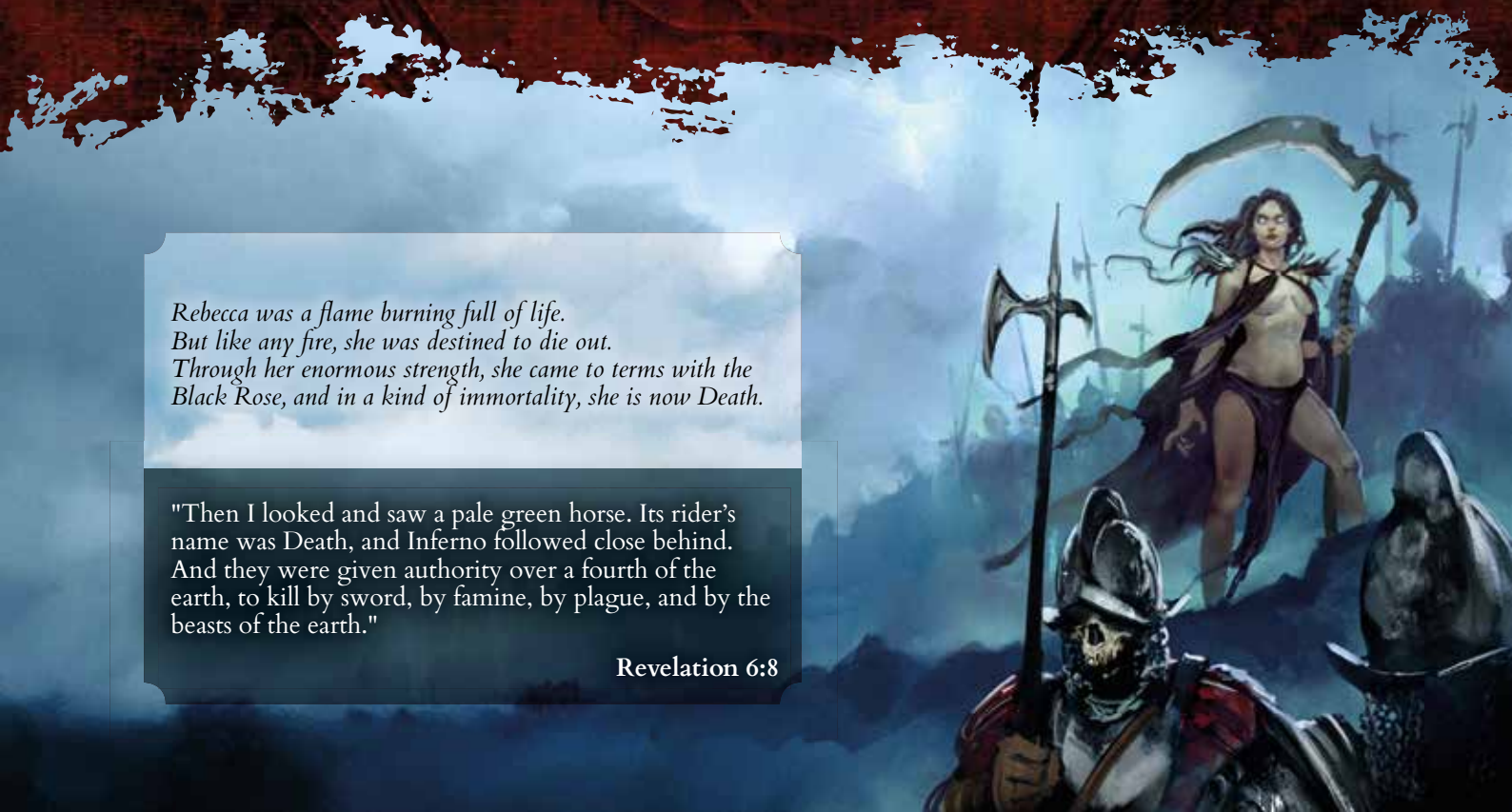
RULES

The Tournament Mode Rules included with this rulebook are meant to be current as of the date of printing and may not accurately reflect the current state of the game. We recommend that you always consult the updated Tournament Mode Rules on our website in order to always have the most up-to-date information and avoid showing up at a Tournament with unusable material.

https://bit.ly/BRWR-Apocalypse

LUDUS MAGNUS STUDIO

Black Rose Wars Apocalypse v.1.0
©2022 Ludus Magnus Studio
All rights reserved
www.ludusmagnusstudio.com



Rebecca was a flame burning full of life.
But like any fire, she was destined to die out.
Through her enormous strength, she came to terms with the Black Rose, and in a kind of immortality, she is now Death.

"Then I looked and saw a pale green horse. Its rider's name was Death, and Inferno followed close behind. And they were given authority over a fourth of the earth, to kill by sword, by famine, by plague, and by the beasts of the earth."

Revelation 6:8